



Things Vowels Do

Dr. Josef Fruehwald

2026-09-12

```
source(here::here("_extensions/mcanouil/typst-render/  
_resources/typst_define.R"))  
source(here::here("_defaults.R"))
```

```
Loading required package: sysfonts
```

```
Loading required package: showtextdb
```

```
library(tidyverse)
```

```
— Attaching core tidyverse packages — tidyverse 2.0.0 —
```

```
✓ dplyr      1.2.1    ✓ readr      2.2.0  
✓ forcats    1.0.1    ✓ stringr    1.6.0  
✓ lubridate  1.9.5    ✓ tibble     3.3.1  
✓ purrr      1.2.2    ✓ tidyr      1.3.2
```

```
— Conflicts — tidyverse_conflicts()  
—
```

```
✖ dplyr::filter() masks stats::filter()
```

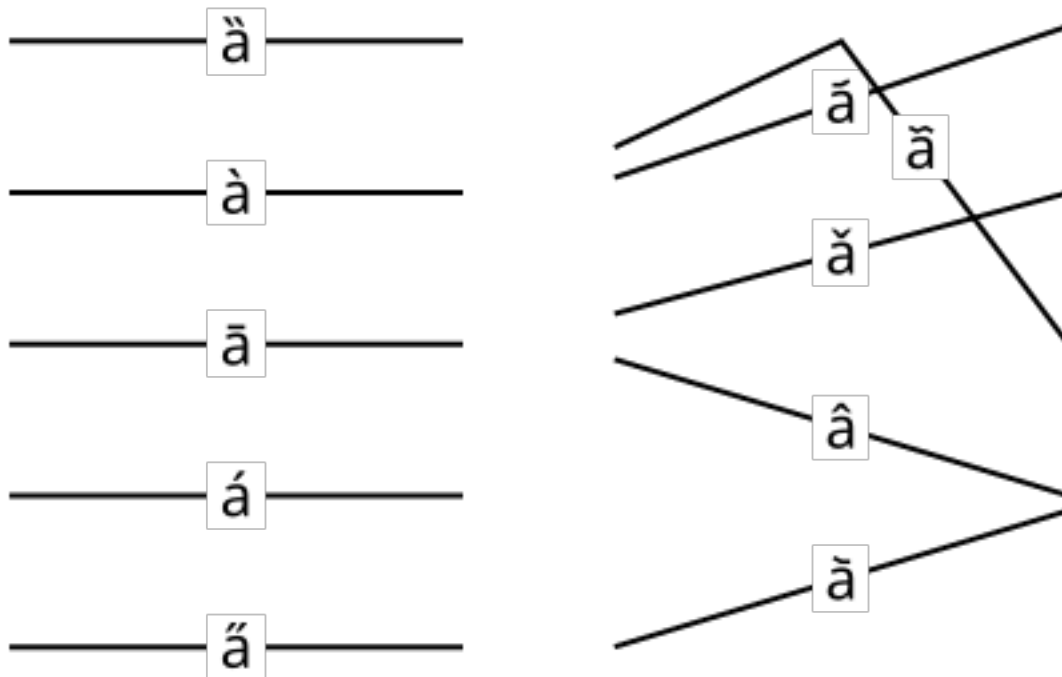
```
✖ dplyr::lag()     masks stats::lag()
```

```
i Use the conflicted package (<http://conflicted.r-lib.org/>) to force all  
conflicts to become errors
```

```
library(ggdiagram)
```



Tone & Intonation



Tone

It's also common to see tone transcribed with small superscript numbers between 1 and 5.

[ma³⁵] vs [ma¹³]

Vowel Variation In Englishes

Back vowel fronting

Goose	[iʊ iɪ y]	[uɪ]	Ghoul
Goat	[əʊ əu ø]	[oɪ]	Goal
Mouth	[aʊ æʊ εɔ]		Foul

Vowel Variation in Englishes

Vowel Variation in Englishes

pre-l laxing



“peat”, “pit”	[p ^h it], [p ^h ɪt]	[p ^h ɪt]	“peel”, “pill”
“poot”, “put”	[p ^h ut], [p ^h ʊt]	[p ^h ʊt]	“pool”, “pull”

Vowel Variation in Englishes

Vowel Variation in Englishes

“Short-a” ~stuff~

“rap”	[ɪæp]	[ɪ ^ɹ m]	“ram”
“mat”	[mæt]	[m ^ɹ n]	“man”
“back”	[bæk]	[b ^ɹ ŋ]	“bang”

Vowel Variation in Englishes

Short vowel lowering

Vowel Variation in Englishes

[aɪ]

	pattern 1	pattern 2	pattern 3	pattern 4	pattern 5?
“type”	[t ^h aɪp]	[t ^h ʌɪp]	[t ^h aɪp]	[t ^h a:p]	[t ^h ʌɪp]
“time”	[t ^h aɪm]	[t ^h aɪm]	[t ^h a:m]	[t ^h a:m]	[t ^h a:m]

Vowel Variation in Englishes

The Southern Shift